

Chapter 129-1

Wang Zhaozhao, Bai Qi, plus Liang Shi—the three of them entered together.

Sun Chengcheng said in a panic, "I'm going to call the police on you for trespassing!"

"Go ahead." Liang Shi stood in her living room with a calm and carefree demeanor.

Xiao Bai chimed in from the side, her tone provocative, "If you don't call, you're a coward!"¹

Sun Chengcheng was so angry she gritted her teeth, but there was nothing she could do about them. She slammed the door shut with a bang, fuming with rage.

She stood at the door and said coldly, "Say what you have to say quickly, then leave after you're done. I still need to sleep!"

Liang Shi unhurriedly scanned every corner of her home, confirming there was nothing unusual inside.

Only then did she say, "Sun Chengcheng, I dreamed about you."

Her tone was bewildered.

Even Xiao Bai was stunned. "Sister Liang, what are you talking about?"

Sun Chengcheng was also startled. Seeing Liang Shi's lowered stance and confused appearance, her anger dissipated at once.

Actually, she quite liked Liang Shi. She was gentle, spoke with discretion, and didn't look down on others just because of her higher status when filming. She would even discuss script changes with her.

Unlike all the other production crews she had been in before and the senior celebrities she had encountered.

But... who told Liang Shi to have a soft personality and be easy to bully?

Stepping on her could help her advance further in the entertainment industry. Only a fool would pass up such an opportunity!

Besides, her agent at the time said he could definitely help her succeed, and provided many case examples to convince her. Sun Chengcheng naturally agreed.

Who would have thought that while she did bring Liang Shi down—even putting her in the hospital with her life uncertain—

She herself also suffered backlash.

Those condemning messages fell on her like snowflakes. Before netizens' keyboards could even rain abuse on her, she had already been collectively blacklisted by people in the industry.

In this circle, if you didn't show your face for a month, the public would already forget what you looked like.

The speed of replacement was faster than cancer cells.

Sun Chengcheng had thought Liang Shi was already dead. But as it turned out... she was actually still alive.

After the initial panic and fear, Sun Chengcheng had regained her composure.

She casually picked up a hair tie from the cabinet, tied up her messy hair, and said coldly, "Why would you dream about me? Disgusting."

When she said the word "disgusting," Liang Shi's eyes swept toward her. Those usually gentle eyes now seemed to carry cold, biting wind and snow. "I'm disgusting? Did I really grope you? When we were filming, did I ever lay a hand on you even once? Aside from necessary contact required by the script, weren't you the one who always took the initiative to touch me?"

Sun Chengcheng was momentarily speechless, but stubbornly insisted like a dead duck with a hard beak,² "I didn't. You were the one who groped me. The internet has already concluded that. What's the point of telling me this now? Anyway, you're finished, and so am I."

Liang Shi laughed coldly. "Then I should at least seek justice for myself. What right do you have to pin things I never did on me? See, you've suffered the backlash now, haven't you?"

She wasn't gloating, but simply stating this fact calmly.

It was precisely this tone that made Sun Chengcheng furious.

That deep, calm tone without a trace of malice was like a crow's curse, directly passing judgment on her actions.

Sun Chengcheng clenched her fists in anger, her eyes red as she retorted: "Is there justice in this world? No! Then why is it that you become famous as soon as you act, but I can't? Everyone around you treats you so well. Even Wang Zhaozhao..."

She paused, "Even someone like Wang Zhaozhao, that famously venomous woman, can be wholeheartedly good to you, while my agent just treats me like a money-making tool? Where am I worse than you?!"

"I'm young, pretty, and have a good figure. I'm also better at flattering people than you. And you? You can't do anything, yet so many people love you. I don't want to see you doing so well! So what! You're just a disgusting pervert who likes women!"

Sun Chengcheng finished her tirade, her voice nearly breaking by the end.

When she cursed out those last few words, a flash of cold severity crossed Liang Shi's calm face.

Xiao Bai immediately rolled up her sleeves and stepped forward to fight, but was stopped before she could even start—Wang Zhaozhao grabbed her arm.³

Xiao Bai was furious beyond measure. "Jiě, let me beat her to death! Born without anyone to teach her manners! What a psycho!"

Wang Zhaozhao shook her head at her. "Shut up!"

But Xiao Bai's eyes were red with anger. "She cursed at Sister Liang!"

Wang Zhaozhao said coldly, "I'm not deaf."

Xiao Bai was like a lion baring its claws and fangs, about ready to scratch Sun Chengcheng. Even without doing so, she cursed angrily: "Sun Chengcheng! Have some shame! If your house doesn't have a mirror, at least you have piss to look at yourself in!⁴ Can you take a look at your own shitty behavior! You think you're young, pretty, and have a good figure? Have some shame! I'm about to throw up my overnight meal!"

Wang Zhaozhao frowned listening to this and patted this "lion" on the back. "Quiet down! Or get out!"

The "lion" looked at her with teary, aggrieved eyes.

Wang Zhaozhao ignored her and directly dragged her out of Sun Chengcheng's home.

After Sun Chengcheng terminated her contract with her company, she didn't have much money. The agent who had done those awful things didn't care about her anymore either. So she could only live in a small low-rent apartment.

Behind the sofa was the bed. There was a semi-open kitchen where the counter could fit at most two pots. Her bed was a mess, and the cabinet was piled with miscellaneous things. It was the kind of place that would drive anyone with OCD or a cleanliness obsession to madness.

The small space instantly fell silent.

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1. If you don't call, you're a coward (不報是孫子): Literally "if you don't report it, you're a grandson." In Chinese, calling someone "grandson" (孫子) is an insult implying they're inferior or cowardly. Xiao Bai is essentially daring Sun Chengcheng to call the police. ↩
 2. Dead duck with a hard beak (死鴨子嘴硬): A Chinese idiom describing someone who refuses to admit they're wrong even when clearly in the wrong, like a dead duck whose beak remains stiff. ↩
 3. Stopped before she could even start (出師未捷身先死): This is a famous line from a poem by Du Fu about the legendary strategist Zhuge Liang, meaning "to die before achieving success in battle." Here it's used humorously to describe Xiao Bai being stopped before she could even start fighting. ↩
 4. Use piss to look at yourself (家裏沒有鏡子總有尿吧): A crude Chinese insult suggesting someone should look at their reflection in their own urine if they don't have a mirror, implying they need to take a good look at how pathetic they are. ↩

Chapter 129-2

Liang Shi spoke first: "I dreamed that you took on a project from a director named Gu Yixue, and that project even had me playing the female lead. I was very confused."

Sun Chengcheng panicked, her eyes darting around.

Gu Yixue... that was a character from her game world.

How could Liang Shi know?

Although there was also a Liang Shi in that world, the two had completely different personalities.

And if this Liang Shi was the same as that Liang Shi, why would she call it a dream?

Sun Chengcheng couldn't figure out the logic, so she went along with Liang Shi's words: "What are you confused about? It's just a dream. Don't tell me you actually think it's real?"

"It was a dream." Liang Shi said. "But that dream was too real. The Gu Yixue in the dream was very beautiful."

Sun Chengcheng: "...What does that have to do with me? I don't know any Gu Yixue at all."

"Oh right." Liang Shi said. "It was also an ABO world. How did you get there?"

"After falling asleep, I just..." Sun Chengcheng let her guard down when she was impatient and subconsciously answered her question. Halfway through, she realized something was wrong and immediately stopped, then tried to cover it up: "Whatever."

"Didn't you just dream about it? Then keep dreaming after you fall asleep." Sun Chengcheng said.

She yawned. "I'm going to sleep. You can leave now."

"It's still daytime." Liang Shi said. "Do you like sleeping that much?"

Sun Chengcheng: "..."

"Is it because after you fall asleep, you can go to that ABO world?" Liang Shi continued.

Sun Chengcheng: "..."

She irritably grabbed at her hair. The closer Liang Shi's guesses got, the more she felt like she was on fire. She couldn't let Liang Shi discover her secret.

Liang Shi continued: "Is that world nice? Is it true that people who like girls aren't called disgusting perverts there, but it's considered normal?"

Sun Chengcheng: "..."

The successive questions caused Sun Chengcheng's psychological defenses to collapse. She completely lost it and said angrily: "Yes yes yes! Whatever you say is right! I go to another world every fucking day after I fall asleep. I grind monsters and level up there. Not only that, I also saw you, and I filmed with that Gu Yixue you mentioned. I had to fucking work with you again! What bad luck!"

Liang Shi: "..."

She suppressed her raging emotions.

She warned herself in her heart: This is a dog. She can't stoop to a dog's level.

After a moment, Liang Shi said: "Then do you know Xu Qingzhu?"

Sun Chengcheng's expression changed drastically... Wasn't that the character card she had just unlocked?

Could it be that Liang Shi had also unlocked some system? Did she know about her main questline?

Sun Chengcheng was panicking inside. Her acting skills weren't yet mature, and she couldn't calmly put on an indifferent expression. When she looked at Liang Shi, she was utterly shocked.

Liang Shi understood—she did know.

But as for why she knew, Liang Shi wasn't clear either. She could only probe step by step.

This was a very troublesome process.

But all Liang Shi wanted to do was have Sun Chengcheng deliver a message.

Liang Shi acted vulnerable and confused. She paused for a moment before saying: "My dreams are very strange—just fragmented things that don't connect. But I heard a voice telling me to find you to deliver a message to Xu Qingzhu."

Sun Chengcheng: "...?"

What the fuck kind of magical world was this?

But looking at Liang Shi's expression, it all seemed real.

Sun Chengcheng didn't dare respond. Since Liang Shi knew about Xu Qingzhu, Sun Chengcheng suspected that her system and tasks had been exposed. She could only wait quietly.

Liang Shi said: "That voice said if you don't deliver this message to Xu Qingzhu, both you and I will die, and we'll die miserably."

Sun Chengcheng was scared: "Wh... what?"

Liang Shi carefully tried to recall, then knocked on her head. "I can't really remember things well after waking up. Wait a moment."

She took out her phone and read from her notes: "The message is—Xu Qingzhu, Liang He¹ wants you to wait a little longer. Everything will get better. Don't cry."

Sun Chengcheng was confused: "Liang He? Who is Liang He?"

Liang Shi shook her head blankly: "I don't know. Anyway, I've delivered the message. Whether you do it or not is up to you. At the time, that voice said if I didn't come find you within three days, my hand would get injured... I didn't want to look for you at first, but my hand really did get injured, on the fourth day."

Liang Shi held out her hand. It was indeed wrapped in bandages.

Though that was actually because she got distracted while cooking and accidentally hurt herself.

But Sun Chengcheng was scared senseless. She stammered: "If... if I-I-I don't deliver the message, w-will we both die?"

She didn't want to die. She was scared.

Liang Shi nodded: "Probably. But I've already died once, so I don't care. It's up to you."

The pressure was completely transferred to Sun Chengcheng.

Liang Shi said lightly: "The message has been delivered. I'm leaving now."

When she reached the door, Sun Chengcheng suddenly stared at her back and asked: "Aren't you going to ask me why I can go to that place?"

Liang Shi had her back to her, her expression somewhat fierce.

She suspected Sun Chengcheng was deliberately trying to provoke her.

Liang Shi did want to ask, but Sun Chengcheng wouldn't possibly tell her.

Besides, she basically already knew. Sun Chengcheng would go there when she slept, becoming the Sun Chengcheng of that world.

As for Qi Jiao, she came here after dying in that world, losing all her memories and gaining a happy, complete family.

There was no pattern to be found in all this.

Liang Shi suppressed all her angry emotions and said coldly: "Everyone has their own privacy. Why would I ask?"

Sun Chengcheng: "..."

Liang Shi said: "I'm only responsible for delivering the message. If I hadn't actually been punished, I wouldn't have come to find you."

Sun Chengcheng bit her lip: "Will there really be punishment?"

"What would I gain from lying to you?" Liang Shi said. "I don't even know who Xu Qingzhu is."

—She did know. It was her wife.

Liang Shi silently apologized to Xu Qingzhu in her heart.

She raised her hand. "Anyway, my hand is injured. If you don't believe me, you can try it yourself."

With that, she opened the door and left.

Leaving Sun Chengcheng standing there in a daze by herself.

What the fuck... was this something she could test?

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1. Liang He (梁合): This is a fake name Liang Shi made up. It sounds similar to "Liang Shi" (梁適) but uses different characters to disguise her identity. "He" (合) means "together" or "united," which could be a subtle hint at wanting to reunite with Xu Qingzhu. ←

Chapter 129-3

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Sun Chengcheng was afraid of death. Extremely afraid.

So after returning, she immediately took out her prepared plan to capture Xu Qingzhu.

The family she had come into was fairly wealthy, but it couldn't compare at all to a family like Xu Qingzhu's. She also couldn't possibly invest in Xu Qingzhu the way Lu Jiayi had, as mentioned on the character card.

She could only take shortcuts.

The character card showed that Lu Jiayi was currently still in the Capital. Going for someone far away while ignoring someone nearby definitely wouldn't work, so Sun Chengcheng would definitely go for Xu Qingzhu first.

She was also afraid of forgetting, so as soon as she came back, she recorded that message on her phone, terrified of getting even one word wrong.

After all, saying it wrong could mean death.

Moreover, after Liang Shi left, Sun Chengcheng thought about it for a long time.

Because Liang Shi said she had only had a fragmented dream and hadn't mentioned too many things about that world—just Gu Yixue and Xu Qingzhu. These two people happened to be the capture target character cards she had drawn. During Gu Yixue's time, it was still considered easy difficulty.

But now that it involved Xu Qingzhu, two people appeared at once, and they needed to be captured in a complementary manner. This was more difficult.

Just when she was at a loss, Liang Shi came to her door.

It was very likely that Liang Shi had brought her clues for her capture mission—this could also be called an assist.

Thinking of this, Sun Chengcheng felt the system was really friendly to her.

The next day after waking up, Sun Chengcheng put on light makeup and picked out a very refreshing outfit from her wardrobe. In Haizhou City's cold season, she wasn't dressed very warmly. As soon as she stepped outside, she shivered from the cold.

Sun Chengcheng drove to the building of Minghui Jewelry. The receptionist said she couldn't enter without an appointment.

She could only stand downstairs and wait. Despite saying many times that she had something to say to President Xu, the receptionist completely ignored her and even replied haughtily: "Everyone who comes here looking for President Xu says that."

Sun Chengcheng was secretly furious but couldn't do anything to the other person.

After waiting all morning, Sun Chengcheng was about to give up. But thinking of the punishment consequences, she could only force herself to persist.

Fortunately, heaven doesn't disappoint those with perseverance.¹ She waited in the first-floor lobby until she saw a cold and aloof beauty. She immediately approached: "President Xu, hello. Someone asked me to deliver a message to you."

Zhou Yi'an: "?"

Zhou Yi'an had been very lazy lately. She didn't come to the company in the morning, and in the afternoon, she would clock in, finish her work, and leave.

This was a privilege Xu Qingzhu had given her.

Mainly because her work efficiency was very high.

Zhou Yi'an never imagined there would be a day in her life when she'd be mistaken for Xu Qingzhu.

She froze for two seconds, then wanted to say "you've got the wrong person," but because her expression was so sour and she wanted to leave, the other person immediately clung to her.

Zhou Yi'an: "..."

So annoying.

Zhou Yi'an frowned and said coldly: "What do you want?"

Sun Chengcheng immediately said: "Someone asked me to deliver a message."

Facing "Xu Qingzhu's" cold face, Sun Chengcheng was somewhat intimidated by her powerful aura. She sighed inwardly that this investor with a discerning eye really lived up to her reputation. But she had to complete her task.

However, what also surprised Sun Chengcheng was that she had already used the affection value buff on Xu Qingzhu. Xu Qingzhu should have liked her very much upon seeing her, so why... It seemed that an affection value of 20 wasn't enough to make her attraction invincible. She would have to work harder on completing tasks in the future.

In that brief moment, Sun Chengcheng thought about many things. At the same time, she rapidly recited that message: "Xu Qingzhu, Liang He wants you to wait a little longer. Everything will get better. Don't cry."

She finished speaking fluently as if reciting a text, then bowed to "Xu Qingzhu." "Sorry for disturbing you. The person who asked me to deliver the message is a friend of mine. I've delivered the message, so I'll be leaving now."

If this message was important to Xu Qingzhu, she would definitely come looking for her.

This was called—playing hard to get.

If it wasn't important... then it was useless.

Sun Chengcheng turned around and almost bumped into someone. Before she could get a good look, she apologized to the other person. But the other person's voice was anxious and cold: "Who is your friend?"

Sun Chengcheng looked up and saw an unforgettable face.

The close-up face attack was at a level that could make even a straight woman like her feel her heart skip a beat.

Sun Chengcheng stepped back half a step and stammered: "Just... just my friend. She only asked me to deliver this message, nothing else. Who are you?"

Zhou Yi'an, who was behind her, asked: "What's your friend's name?"

Sun Chengcheng swallowed. She felt like the air around her was about to freeze solid. The people in front and behind her both had powerful auras, staring at her intensely as if they were going to bore a hole through her with their gazes.

Sun Chengcheng immediately said: "Just... just an ordinary friend."

"Name." Zhou Yi'an lowered her voice.

She naturally carried a somewhat roguish air, with a slightly wicked look when she smiled. Right now, she was deliberately releasing her powerful aura.

An Alpha's pheromones would exert pressure on Omegas—this was an innate instinct in the body.

Xu Qingzhu sensed something was wrong. She glared at Zhou Yi'an and walked further away.

Sun Chengcheng felt her legs going weak and instinctively reached out to grab Zhou Yi'an, but Zhou Yi'an dodged.

It was at this moment that Sun Chengcheng finally understood—this person was an Alpha, which meant she wasn't Xu Qingzhu, because Xu Qingzhu was an Omega!

"You're not Xu Qingzhu?" Sun Chengcheng asked.

Xu Qingzhu said: "I am. So can you tell me your friend's name?"

Sun Chengcheng couldn't withstand this oppressive feeling and said coldly: "Her name is Liang Shi. I don't know anything else."

Sun Chengcheng said: "Those were her dying words... I'm only responsible for delivering the message."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

For some reason, after saying this, Sun Chengcheng felt like the air around her had frozen solid.

And she still needed to capture Xu Qingzhu.

She showed Xu Qingzhu a weak smile: "Sorry, my tone was a bit harsh just now."

"It's fine. You look a bit unwell. Why don't you come up for some tea?" Xu Qingzhu said.

1. Heaven doesn't disappoint those with perseverance (皇天不負有心人): A Chinese proverb meaning that if you work hard and persevere, you will eventually be rewarded. Similar to "fortune favors the persistent" or "where there's a will, there's a way." ⇐

Chapter 129-4

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Xu Qingzhu actually had quite a favorable impression of this person who suddenly appeared—provided she hadn't said those words about dying wishes.

Between people, there's always a matter of personal chemistry.¹

This person happened to suit her chemistry quite well, it's just...

Xu Qingzhu let out a soft breath to calm her emotions. In the office, she asked Sun Chengcheng again, but the information she got was just that.

There wasn't much more content.

Xu Qingzhu hosted her for tea, treated her to snacks, and even dinner.

They exchanged contact information.

Xu Qingzhu said she didn't really understand the content of the message either, but still had her relay a response: "Thank you for the concern. Everything is well."

Xu Qingzhu said this was just being polite.

Sun Chengcheng let her guard down.

After Sun Chengcheng left, Xu Qingzhu immediately had someone investigate her background.

It was a very normal and unremarkable file.

But that evening, there was a new message on Liang Shi's phone. It was from Gu Yixue: [Are you not in contact with Sun Chengcheng anymore?]

Soon followed by another message: [I've rested enough. Is your schedule free yet?]

Xu Qingzhu was surprised to see the name Sun Chengcheng. She then politely replied to Gu Yixue using Liang Shi's phone, explaining the current situation.

Then she noticed a document titled "Clarification" on Liang Shi's phone's home screen.

She tapped into it. The first sentence was—As an artist, I know that learning art means first learning virtue. Not being able to attend university wasn't my fault, but I can say with a clear conscience that there are no problems with my morals. I did not sexually harass Sun Chengcheng while filming, and there was absolutely no inappropriate touching just because I like girls...

It went on for nearly a thousand words.

Xu Qingzhu also learned who this Sun Chengcheng was.

Liang Shi had mentioned it to her before. Liang Shi said she clearly hadn't done anything there, yet people still cursed at her. Rumors and gossip kept being hurled at her, and all she could do was endure it.

Xu Qingzhu finished reading that clarification document with tears in her eyes.

So it was true after all—she had gone back.

Back to her world.

Before she could even sort out her thoughts, she received a call from Zhou Yi'an.

Zhou Yi'an asked bluntly: "Liang He... that's actually Liang Shi, right?"

Xu Qingzhu remained silent and didn't respond.

Zhou Yi'an continued: "Then what about the previous Liang Shi?"

That crazy, irritable Liang Shi with eyes full of hostility.

Xu Qingzhu let out a soft breath: "I don't know."

She couldn't even get her own lover back, let alone someone else's lover.

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On the way back from Sun Chengcheng's place, Liang Shi said solemnly to Wang Zhaozhao: "Sister Wang, can you help me hold a press conference?"

Wang Zhaozhao raised an eyebrow: "For what? Making a comeback?"

Liang Shi shook her head and smiled: "No, it's a press conference for leaving the industry."

She would definitely find a way to return to Xu Qingzhu's side. Even if she really couldn't go back, she wouldn't be an actress in this world anymore.

She said in a deep voice: "I want to be someone with a clear conscience."

Those baseless accusations—she wouldn't accept them.

Xiao Bai was a bit sad. "Sister Liang, are you really giving up just like that? People are actually quite tolerant of these things now."

"It's fine." Liang Shi patted her head. "I'll do baking with you."

"Wouldn't that be a waste of talent?" Xiao Bai shook her head. "No way, you should be a shareholder instead."

Liang Shi chuckled lightly. She said to Wang Zhaozhao: "It's also a clarification press conference."

Wang Zhaozhao thought for a moment. "So you've still decided to go back?"

Xiao Bai was confused: "Go back? Go where?"

Wang Zhaozhao scoffed: "Don't ask questions you shouldn't ask."

Liang Shi said: "I haven't found a way yet... but if there's a chance, I probably will."

For now, she could only place her hopes on that garbage system.

All it knew how to do was create bugs all day long!

It infuriated her.

But Liang Shi suddenly had a flash of inspiration. She seemed to know what she, Sun Chengcheng, and Qi Jiao had in common!

—They all seemed to have exchanged time and space because of their wishes and obsessions!

1. Personal chemistry / eye affinity (眼緣): A Chinese concept referring to the immediate favorable impression or natural affinity one feels when first seeing someone. It's the idea that some people just "click" at first sight, not necessarily romantically, but in terms of general likeability. ⇐